



Apple's AR/VR still far away

Apple analyst Ming-Chi Kuo says long awaited AR/VR hardware is still in the works, not ready for reveal. <https://digit.in/jun22-68>



GlaxoSmithKline goes big

GSK to buy vaccine developer Affinivax for \$2.1b, with additional payments up to \$1.2b more. <https://digit.in/jun22-69>

THE EVOLUTION OF CAMERA PHOTOGRAPHY IN INDIA

A look back at how Camera Phones transformed personal photography

Siddharth Chauhan |
siddharth@digit.in

I still remember dropping my jaw to the floor when I saw the first phone with a camera which was a

Nokia Supernova. It was a time when phone makers were being siloed into the Android and iOS camp. Today, cameras have become part and parcel of the smartphone world and are right in the centre of digital convergence. Especially in India, the world's second-largest smartphone market. If you look back, it took just about 12 years for cameras to become a highlight of the conventional smartphone. However, the roots of the "camera phone" concept date back almost 23 years and even earlier. We saw them as parts of prototypes and unreleased products of clandestine research



Apple's prototype of a videophone in 1995

divisions of some of the world's leading tech companies.

COMING OF AGE FOR CAMERA PHONES

The first picture ever taken from a camera phone is credited to Philippe Kahn. He combined a Casio QV-10 camera with the Motorola StarTAC flip phone (two iconic products of the 90s) to document the birth of his daughter.

In the years leading up to 2010, more smartphone brands became comfortable with the idea of the camera being a major area of focus. However, it wasn't until 2010 that the camera inside a smartphone got advanced enough to be considered a decently viable alternative to compact point and shoot cameras. After that though, between 2010 and 2018, the

sale of point-and-shoot and compact digital cameras plummeted by over 84 per cent, giving rise to smartphone photography. It also helped that the same device could also be used for making calls, sending texts, listening to music, and much more.

All these years later, capturing a picture or a video using a smartphone has become second nature for most of India's 750 million smartphone users. This

has empowered many phone users to bolster their confidence in front of cameras. People also get a taste of virality, with so much video and photo content being produced and shared on social media apps like Instagram, TikTok, and Snapchat. It has contributed to camera phone photography or smartphone photography as a separate genre within mainstream photography in India.



Picture by Philippe Kahn

BREAKTHROUGHS IN MODERN SMARTPHONE PHOTOGRAPHY

2010 was the year when we saw a lot of camera innovations. The one phone that stood out, in particular, was the Nokia N8. It was ahead of its time as it had a 12-megapixel camera with a large 1/1.83-inch sensor, developed in partnership with Carl Zeiss optics. These features alone rivalled the best point-and-shoot cameras available at the time. But it came in after a long wait and at a tremulous phase for Nokia. Nonetheless, it set a benchmark for the